

Concept Document: Lamport General Systems

1.0 Game Title & Logline

1. **Game Title:** *Lamport General Systems*
2. **Logline:** *Lamport General Systems* is a first-person immersive-sim where you play as a lone technician in a derelict facility, manipulating a self-repairing network of robots and computers that has turned against you while uncovering the consequences of corporate neglect and deciding the fate of a mysterious AI.

2.0 High-Level Premise

In Lamport Systems, you play as a lone technician sent by a massive corporation to a long-abandoned facility. The facility is full of computers including humanoid robots that are designed to repair themselves and keep working even when parts of the system fail. These computers operate as a Byzantine Fault Tolerant system, meaning they continue to function correctly even when some nodes behave unpredictably or maliciously. Your job is to manipulate the system using stealth, physical sabotage, and low-level programming. You can intercept, edit, or replay messages between computers to change how they behave. Every action is risky because the network adapts, recovers, and reacts to your interference, creating tension, surprising situations, and emergent outcomes that reward creative problem solving. As you explore, you discover unfinished experiments, broken machinery, and signs that human oversight was minimal. These details highlight the dangers of relying too much on automated systems and AI and show the consequences of corporate neglect. The game emphasizes immersive sim gameplay, allowing you to experiment with multiple approaches and combinations of mechanics and see how the system responds in unpredictable ways.

3.0 Player Experience Goals

- **Impossible Stewardship**
 - Players feel the weight of being sole technician of a vast, failed system, tasked with an impossible corporate mandate to restore (or condemn) a derelict site alone
- **Strategic Infiltration**
 - Players strategize their approach using stealth, brute force, exploits, or writing low-level code under pressure to crack resistant machines and systems
- **System Awe**

- Players feel both awe and dread at the network's resilience: no matter how many nodes they disable, the interconnected system adapts and recovers
- **Emergent Satisfaction**
 - Players experience creative breakthroughs and surprising moments when their disruptions cause unexpected system behaviors (corrupted messages, conflicting protocols) that create new opportunities

4.0 Core Gameplay Mechanics

- **Message Manipulation:** Intercept, edit, replay, or manufacture messages to control nodes.
- **Instruction Injection:** Temporarily patch nodes with low-level code.
- **Node Sabotage:** Cause nodes to fail or isolate them physically (power cuts, broken links).
- **Observation & Stealth:** Hide, move carefully, and avoid detection by autonomous systems.
- **Emergent Interaction:** Every action affects the network, producing unexpected consequences and new opportunities.

5.0 Story and Theme

- **Story:**

In Lamport Systems, you are a lone technician sent by a massive corporation to a long-abandoned facility tasked with restoring the site to working order. The company left you on the job alone with minimal tools, forcing you to scavenge and improvise, a clear sign that efficiency and profit were valued over worker safety and support. The facility is dominated by a network of self-repairing humanoid robots and computers, which continue to operate relentlessly even decades after abandonment. The company left you on the job alone as efficiency and profit are more important than worker safety or support.

As you explore, you discover traces of the corporation's neglect: unfinished experiments, malfunctioning machinery, and cryptic logs that hint at human overreach and the dangers of over-reliance on AI. Amid the network, you encounter a unique AI entity that behaves differently from the system working against you—a beam of light with consciousness. Its existence poses a moral dilemma: do you embrace the potential benefits of technology and save it, or reject AI entirely and delete it?

Questions emerge as you delve deeper: why is the AI hostile toward you when the system was originally designed to be resilient and prevent this from happening? Perhaps it gained too much power and began manipulating the system to its own ends, or perhaps a previous worker, fed up with corporate neglect, sabotaged the network and left it in a dangerous, self-protective state. The story explores these mysteries while examining the

tension between technological progress, human oversight, and the ethical responsibilities that come with creating powerful AI systems.

- **Themes:**

- **Corporate Neglect and Capitalist Structures:** The game explores the consequences of a corporation prioritizing profit and efficiency over worker safety and support. The player's isolation reflects how systems can fail to account for human needs.
- **Human vs. Automation:** The game reflects on the dangers of overreliance on automated systems and AI. Players confront the difficulty of controlling, manipulating, or overriding machines that were designed to operate without human guidance.
- **Resilience and Emergent Systems:** Through the facility's humanoid robots and computers, the game examines fault-tolerant systems and emergent behavior. Players experience how interconnected networks can adapt, recover, and react unpredictably, creating complex challenges.

6.0 Target Audience & Comparables

1. **Target Audience:** The game is designed for players who enjoy immersive sims, emergent gameplay, and horror. It appeals to those who like tense, atmospheric worlds where systems respond dynamically to player actions. Players who enjoy high-stakes problem-solving, moral dilemmas, and the dread of being alone against a resilient, adaptive network of AI and robots will find this game engaging. Fans of sci-fi, retrofuturism, and narrative-driven exploration will also be drawn to the setting and themes of corporate neglect and over-reliance on automation.
2. **Comparable Titles:**

Comparable Title	Inspiration & Differentiation
Soma	Inspires.... - Horror atmosphere and tension. - Environmental storytelling and exposition through computer logs - Encounters with autonomous entities that create suspense. Differs by.... - Focusing on linear storytelling rather than emergence and systems
Alien Isolation	Inspires.... - Fear and tension from being alone against a relentless, intelligent adversary. - Adaptive enemy behavior that reacts to the player. Differs by....

Prey	Inspires.... - Exploration of high-tech facilities. - Enemies and systems that respond to player actions. - Emergent gameplay Differs by....
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